Experiment 5: Reports, Dashboards, and UI Builder

1. AIM

To create and configure reports, dashboards, and user interfaces using Zoho Creator, and to understand how application data can be displayed, analyzed, and presented through visual components.

2. THEORY

Reports

Reports are used to display, organize, filter, and analyze records collected through application forms. Zoho Creator provides different report types that allow users to view data according to their requirements.

The major report types include:

- **List View:** Displays records in a tabular or list format.
- **Spreadsheet View:** Displays records in a grid and can support inline editing where configured.
- **Kanban View:** Organizes records into columns based on a selected status or category.
- **Calendar View:** Displays records according to date fields.
- **Map View:** Displays location-based records on a map when suitable location data is configured.
- **Timeline View:** Presents records or activities along a timeline.
- **Pivot Table:** Summarizes and compares data across categories.
- **Chart View:** Represents data graphically using charts.
- **Summary View:** Groups and summarizes records to provide an overview of important information.

Dashboards

A dashboard is a visual interface that combines important information from an application into a single view. It helps users monitor performance, identify trends, and make decisions efficiently.

Dashboards can include charts, reports, summary information, and other visual components. For example, a vehicle service dashboard can display the total number of service requests, pending repairs, completed services, and service demand by vehicle type.

UI Builder

The User Interface (UI) Builder is a visual development tool used to design customized application pages. It allows developers to arrange components such as text, buttons, forms, reports, charts, images, and panels.

A well-designed user interface improves usability by organizing information clearly and making application functions easy to access.

The main advantages of reports, dashboards, and UI builders are improved data visualization, easier monitoring, better decision-making, and reduced manual development effort.

3. PROCEDURE

A. Creating Reports

1. Log in to Zoho Creator and open the required application.
2. Navigate to the application builder.
3. Select the option to create a new report.
4. Choose the source form whose records must be displayed.
5. Select an appropriate report type, such as List, Kanban, Calendar, Pivot Table, or Chart.
6. Enter a suitable report name.
7. Configure the fields to be displayed in the report.
8. Apply sorting, filtering, grouping, or aggregation where required.
9. Save the report and preview the displayed records.

B. Creating a Dashboard

1. Open the application builder and navigate to the Pages or UI Builder section.
2. Create a new page for the dashboard.
3. Enter a suitable page name.
4. Add visual components such as charts, reports, summary information, and text.
5. Configure the components to display relevant application data.
6. Arrange the components in a clear and organized layout.
7. Save the page and preview the dashboard.
8. Verify that the dashboard displays the required information correctly.

C. Designing the User Interface

1. Open the UI Builder or page builder.
2. Create a new page or open an existing page.
3. Add components such as headings, text, buttons, images, forms, and reports.
4. Configure the properties of each component.
5. Arrange the components to provide a user-friendly layout.
6. Configure navigation or actions for interactive components where supported.
7. Save and preview the page.

8. Test the interface to verify that the components work as intended.

4. APPLICATION EXAMPLE

A Vehicle Service & Repair Request Management application can use the following reports and dashboard components.

Component	Purpose
All Service Requests List	Displays all service requests
Service Status Kanban	Tracks requests by repair status
Service Schedule Calendar	Displays scheduled services
Vehicle Type Pivot Table	Compares vehicle and service categories
Service Type Chart	Visualizes demand by service type
Vehicle Type Summary	Summarizes service records by vehicle type
Dashboard	Displays important service statistics and charts
Custom UI Page	Provides convenient navigation to application features

For example, a dashboard can display:

- Total service requests
- Pending service requests
- Completed repairs
- Service requests by vehicle type
- Service demand by service category
- Upcoming service appointments

5. RESULT

Reports, dashboards, and user interfaces were successfully studied using Zoho Creator. Reports were configured to display and analyze application records, a dashboard was designed to present important information visually, and the UI Builder was explored to understand the creation of customized application pages.

Thus, the experiment demonstrated how Zoho Creator simplifies data presentation, visualization, monitoring, and user-interface development through low-code tools.

Create New Component

Create your component from scratch


Form


Report


Page


Workflow

Which type of report would you like to make?

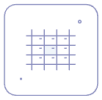

List


Pivot Chart


Pivot Table

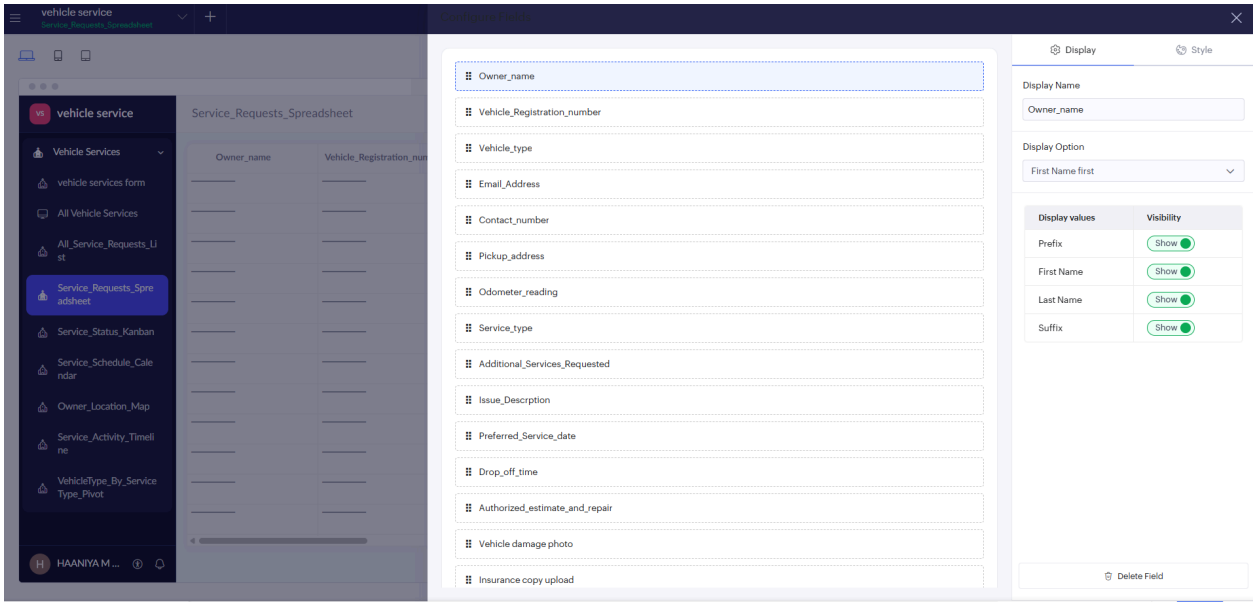

Spreadsheet

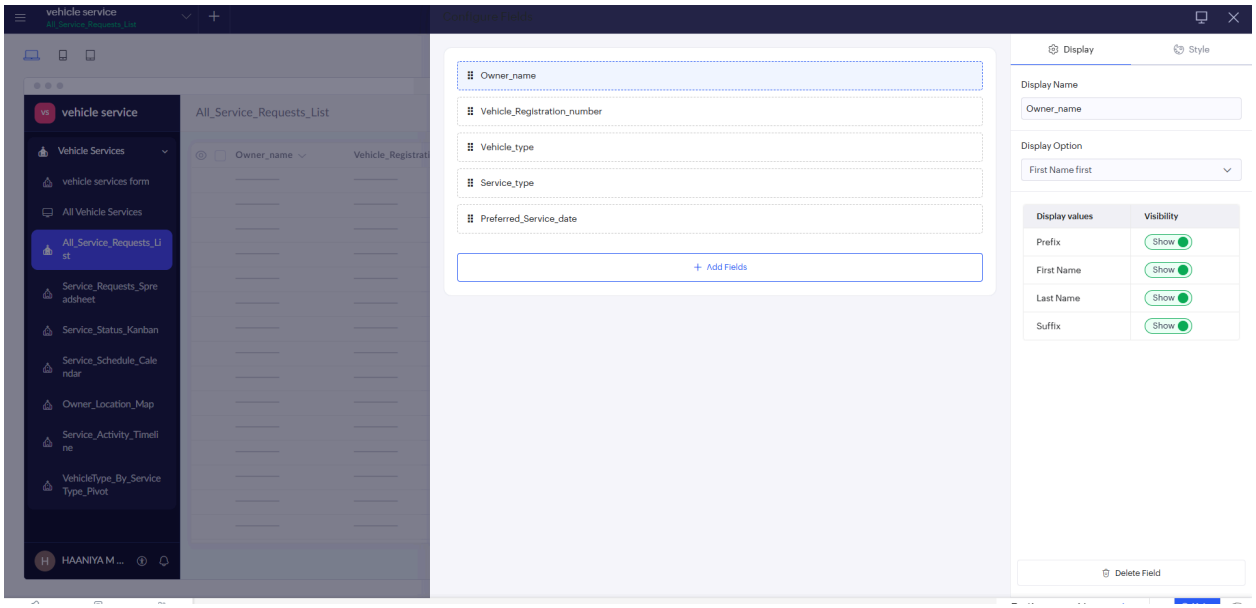

Kanban


Calendar


Timeline


Map


vehicle service
Service_Requests_Spreadsheet
Configure Fields
Owner_name
Vehicle_Registration_number
Vehicle_type
Email_Address
Contact_number
Pickup_address
Odometer_reading
Service_type
Additional_Services_Requested
Issue_Descrption
Preferred_Service_date
Drop_off_time
Authorized_estimate_and_repair
Vehicle damage photo
Insurance copy upload
Display
Style
Display Name
Owner_name
Display Option
First Name first
Display values
Visibility
Prefix
First Name
Last Name
Suffix
Show
Delete Field
Vehicle Services
vehicle services form
All Vehicle Services
All_Service_Requests_List
Service_Requests_Spreadsheet
Service_Status_Kanban
Service_Schedule_Calendar
Owner_Location_Map
Service_Activity_Timeline
VehicleType_By_Service Type_Pivot
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vehicle service
All_Service_Requests_List
Configure Fields
Owner_name
Vehicle_Registration_number
Vehicle_type
Service_type
Preferred_Service_date
+ Add Fields
Display
Style
Display Name
Owner_name
Display Option
First Name first
Display values
Visibility
Prefix
First Name
Last Name
Suffix
Show
Delete Field
Vehicle Services
vehicle services form
All Vehicle Services
All_Service_Requests_List
Service_Requests_Spreadsheet
Service_Status_Kanban
Service_Schedule_Calendar
Owner_Location_Map
Service_Activity_Timeline
VehicleType_By_Service Type_Pivot
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